

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
MUMBAI POLICE
FIRST INFORMATION REPORT (FIR)
(Under Section 154 Cr.P.C.)

FIR No.:	234/2024	Date:	08-01-2024
Police Station:	Andheri (West)	District:	Mumbai
Act & Section:	IPC 420, 468, 471, 120B	Cognizable:	Yes

COMPLAINANT DETAILS

Name: Vikram Mehta | Age: 41 years | Occupation: Software Engineer
Address: Flat 402, Sai Residency, Andheri West, Mumbai – 400058
Mobile: 98XXXXXXX | Email: vikram.mehta@email.com

ACCUSED DETAILS

Name: Pradeep Kumar Sharma | Age: 38 years
Occupation: Self-proclaimed Financial Advisor
Address: Room 12, Janta Colony, Dharavi, Mumbai – 400017
Firm name (fake): 'Sharma Wealth Management Pvt. Ltd.'

OFFENCE DETAILS

Date of Offence: July 2023 to December 2023 (continuous)
Place of Offence: Andheri West, Mumbai and Online
Amount Defrauded: Rs. 25,00,000/- (Rupees Twenty-Five Lakhs Only)

BRIEF FACTS AND COMPLAINT

The complainant Vikram Mehta states that in July 2023, he was approached by the accused Pradeep Kumar Sharma who introduced himself as a SEBI-registered financial advisor and proprietor of 'Sharma Wealth Management Pvt. Ltd.' The accused showed the complainant fake certificates purportedly issued by SEBI and Reserve Bank of India showing his registration as a portfolio manager. The accused represented that he had exclusive access to pre-IPO shares of major companies and could guarantee returns of 35-40% per annum. Induced by these fraudulent representations, the complainant transferred a total of Rs. 25,00,000/- (Rupees Twenty-Five Lakhs) to bank accounts provided by the accused in six instalments between July 2023 and December 2023. The amounts were transferred to three different bank accounts — HDFC Bank Account No. 50100XXXXXX in the name of 'Sharma Wealth Management', ICICI Bank Account No. 0262XXXXXX in accused's personal name, and a Paytm payment bank account. When the complainant sought returns on his investment in January 2024, the accused became evasive and later switched off his phone. Upon inquiry with SEBI directly, the complainant discovered that: (1) No such entity 'Sharma Wealth Management Pvt. Ltd.' is registered with SEBI; (2) The accused has no SEBI registration; (3) The certificates shown are forged and fabricated. The complainant also learned that two other victims — Sunita Shah and Rohit Jain — were similarly defrauded by the

accused with same modus operandi. The total amount defrauded from all victims is estimated at Rs. 45,00,000/-.

MODUS OPERANDI

1. Target identification: Accused targeted middle-class professionals through social media and word of mouth. 2. Trust building: Showed fake SEBI certificates and fabricated investment portfolios. 3. Inducement: Promised 35-40% returns which are illegal under SEBI regulations. 4. Money collection: Collected funds in multiple accounts to obscure money trail. 5. Disappearance: After collecting substantial amounts, accused became unavailable.

SECTIONS APPLICABLE

IPC Section 420: Cheating and dishonestly inducing delivery of property — Punishment: Up to 7 years imprisonment + fine. IPC Section 468: Forgery for purpose of cheating — Punishment: Up to 7 years + fine. IPC Section 471: Using forged document as genuine — Punishment: Up to 2 years + fine. IPC Section 120B: Criminal conspiracy — Punishment: As per the offence conspired.

Registered by: Sub-Inspector Ramesh Patil, Andheri (West) PS, Mumbai

Date & Time of Registration: 08-01-2024, 14:30 hrs